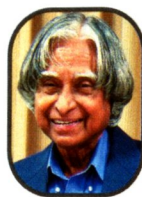




THE GREAT NEED

A Transformation in Thinking



■ By A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

So what is the Spirit of India? While celebrating this intrinsic nature of India, I reflected on the history of the country and then extended my voyage to the future.

As a nation, we are proud of our civilisational heritage, our family-oriented society, our unity amidst cultural diversity, our innovative method of

ahimsa dharma that liberated us from foreign rule and our well-tested and stable democracy with its all-round growth in different sectors of economy. India is now a country that exudes confidence and gives rise to hopes to deal with the challenges. I see the spirit of India in the capacity of its people to do their work and lead a contented life.

There are so many aspects that I find it difficult to sum up this spirit. Can I share with you how India graduated within a decade from a country about to be forced to pledge gold to meet its foreign exchange needs to a nation that is now growing at an average annual rate of 9 per cent GDP? Or how the farmers in partnership with scientists and technologists succeeded in producing over 200

million tonne of foodgrain and made the nation almost self-sufficient? Or should I tell you the story of how India succeeded in launching 10 satellites through a single launch and is about to embark on a mission to the moon? Shall I mention with pride the capability of our nuclear scientists in reprocessing the high burn-up carbide fuel using sodium-cooled fast reactors? Or share my experience of how India became a nuclear weapon state? Shall I write about the recent achievements of our defence scientists in testing strategic missile systems?

There is so much more: shall I describe the growth in production of generic drugs by our pharmaceutical industry through advanced research?



SAURABH SINGH